



Chevening Application Form

Award programme: Chevening Scholarship 2026-2027

Application country: Malawi

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National Registration Bureau, Dedza District Council, P.O Box 140, Dedza, Malawi
Lilongwe

Box 140, Dedza

Malawi

Employment history:

Internet of Things Short Course Facilitator

Mzuzu University (UN women GirlCanCode program)

Freelance

Technology and industry

06 Jun 2024

40.00 hours per week

ICT Support Technician

Mzuzu University

Unpaid internship

Technology and industry

01 Mar 2021 - 10 Jun 2022

40.00 hours per week

Computer Teacher

Saint George Academy

Full time

Education and teaching

20 Feb 2022 - 10 Mar 2023

50.00 hours per week

Registration Officer(Grade I)

National Registration Bureau

Full time
Police, law enforcement and criminology
10 May 2023
40.00 hours per week

Education history:

Mzuzu University

Information and Communication Technology
BSc
Malawi
12 Sep 2016 - 03 Dec 2020
Cumulative GPA: 65

UK university / course selections:

First choice

University of the West of Scotland
Internet of Things

Second choice

Edinburgh Napier University
Digital Technologies for Smart Cities

Third choice

Edinburgh Napier University
Robotics and Autonomous Systems Engineering

Assessed application answers:

1. Leadership experience

In my capacity as Deputy Head of Office at the National Registration Bureau(Dedza District Registration Office), I have consistently demonstrated leadership in coordinating large-scale national registration activities. One of the significant challenges I encountered was ensuring the smooth execution of field registration exercises, which required deploying both officers and security personnel to multiple registration centers across diverse locations and assisting other districts in executing the mass registration exercises. The complexity of this task lay in balancing limited resources with the need to provide efficient, secure, and citizen-friendly services.

To address this challenge, I conducted detailed assessments of operational needs at each registration center, carefully analyzing staffing gaps, security requirements, and logistical demands. Based on this assessment, I developed and implemented deployment strategies that ensured equitable distribution of officers and security personnel. I also established clear communication channels with field teams and introduced daily reporting structures to monitor progress, quickly resolve emerging issues, and maintain

accountability.

The outcome was a successful registration exercise characterized by improved efficiency, minimal disruptions, and enhanced public confidence in the process. Citizens were served in an orderly manner, while security incidents were effectively prevented through proactive planning.

This experience reinforced my belief that leadership is about responsibility, foresight, and empowering others to succeed. I learned the importance of adapting dynamic environments, the value of transparent communication, and the necessity of making timely decisions under pressure. These lessons continue to shape my approach to leadership, where I prioritize collaboration, fairness, and accountability in every role I undertake.

2. Relationship building and influence

One of the most impactful professional relationships I have built began during an E-waste Hackathon in Rwanda, where I formed a team with two Kenyan innovators. Together, we developed an innovative e-waste management solution, and the partnership proved so promising that we registered it in Kenya, with plans to extend the initiative to Malawi. This relationship was important because it demonstrated the power of cross-border collaboration in addressing pressing environmental challenges, while also exposing me to diverse perspectives and approaches.

My contribution to this partnership lay in providing technical expertise, coordinating the project design, and ensuring our solution was practical and scalable. In return, I gained valuable insights into collaborative innovation and international teamwork. Beyond the technical project, this relationship has grown into a long-term partnership, strengthened through regular communication and a shared vision for expanding sustainable e-waste management solutions in our respective countries.

At the National Registration Bureau, I have also cultivated strategic relationships with organizations such as World Vision, aligning birth registration initiatives with child protection policies. This collaboration has been instrumental in extending registration services to vulnerable communities, and it has reinforced my ability to build trust, align goals, and create mutually beneficial outcomes.

Over time, I have sustained these relationships by prioritizing transparency, maintaining consistent engagement, and ensuring that outcomes benefit all stakeholders involved. These experiences have honed my ability to influence through collaboration rather than authority, and to create networks that deliver sustainable impact.

I believe these skills will enable me to build meaningful connections within the Chevening community and beyond. By fostering mutual respect, open dialogue, and shared objectives, I will not only contribute to the Chevening network but also leverage it to create lasting solutions that transcend borders.

3. Course choice and global challenge

The UK priority area I wish to address is sustainable development through science, technology, and innovation. Many of Malawi's pressing challenges including waste

management, public health delivery, and digital governance require innovative technological solutions that can scale in resource-constrained settings. My vision is to harness the Internet of Things (IoT) to design and implement such solutions, building on projects I have already initiated such as the SmartBin system for environmental management and the MedCard system for digital medical records.

The MSc Internet of Things at the University of the West of Scotland is uniquely suited to equip me with the advanced technical knowledge and research skills needed to address these challenges. The programme's strong focus on applied IoT systems, data analytics, and cloud integration aligns directly with my ambition to develop scalable edge solutions that combine hardware, software, and data intelligence. Furthermore, University of West Scotland has a reputation for fostering innovation and entrepreneurship, which will enable me to transform research into impactful community solutions.

I selected the University of the West of Scotland because of its emphasis on real-world application of IoT technologies and its collaborative research environment. The institution's track record in producing graduates who lead technological innovation resonates with my goal of becoming a key contributor to Malawi's digital transformation agenda.

Upon completion of my studies, I plan to immediately apply my knowledge by strengthening my ongoing projects. The SmartBin system will be expanded as a national solution for efficient waste management, contributing to cleaner cities and climate resilience. The MedCard project will be scaled to improve healthcare access, record management, and policy alignment in Malawi. Beyond these projects, I intend to collaborate with government and development partners to build a robust IoT innovation ecosystem that addresses broader challenges in agriculture, education, and governance.

4. Career plan and impact

In the medium term, my goal is to strengthen and scale IoT-based solutions that address Malawi's pressing challenges in healthcare and environmental management. After completing my MSc in Internet of Things at the University of the West of Scotland, I plan to expand the SmartBin system into a national initiative for efficient waste management and climate resilience. I will also advance the MedCard project into a digital health platform that improves patient record management, enhances service delivery, and supports government policy implementation.

In the long term, I aspire to establish a Technology Innovation Hub in Malawi to drive research, development, and deployment of IoT solutions across sectors such as agriculture, education, and governance. This hub will also nurture young innovators and foster public-private partnerships to accelerate digital transformation and create employment opportunities.

I anticipate challenges such as limited funding, infrastructure gaps, and resistance to new technologies. To address these, I will leverage partnerships with NGOs, government, and international organizations, an approach I have already practiced at the National Registration Bureau by collaborating with World Vision to integrate birth registration with child protection services.

Chevening will be instrumental in achieving these ambitions by equipping me with advanced technical expertise and a global network of professionals. This combination of knowledge and influence will strengthen my capacity to build partnerships, advocate for enabling policies, and scale innovative solutions. With Chevening's support, I will return to Malawi ready to champion technology-driven transformation and contribute directly to sustainable development.

Referees:

Felix Joseph Kholowa

Chief Human Resource Management Officer

Stanley Ndebvu

Lecturer